Sarcoidosis is a systemic disease in which abnormal collections of cells (granulomas) form, primarily in the intrathoracic lymph nodes. Diagnosis is typically made via an abnormal chest xray as most patients exhibit no symptoms at the time the disease is discovered.

As granulomas occur in other structures, other complications may develop such as uveitis from ocular sarcoidosis, conduction defects from myocardial sarcoidosis, laryngeal obstruction from endobronchial sarcoidosis, and facial nerve palsy. Cor pulmonale may develop and hypercalcemia occurs in about 10% of patients. Steroids are administered to suppress the disease and control the hypercalcemia.

Hines RL, Marschall KE. Stoeltings Anesthesia & Co-Existing Diseases. 6th ed. New York, NY: Churchill-Livingston; 2012: 200.

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